

Back to Paper

Students complete a traditional paper-based MCQ test under invigilated conditions.

HOW IT WORKS

- Students sit a timed on-campus assessment without access to phones, laptops, notes, or other resources.
- Multiple versions of the paper can be created by changing question and answer-option order.
- Answer sheets are marked manually or processed using optical mark recognition.
- Online quizzes may support practice, but the paper test determines the summative mark.

SHARED ASSUMPTIONS

- The assessment strategy must be used with more than 500 students.
- The MCQ assessment contributes 40% of the final mark for a 15-credit module.
- Assume that any proposed approach is technically possible. Focus on whether it is educationally desirable and defensible in practice.

ROUND 1: DEVELOP YOUR PITCH

You have five minutes to prepare a one-minute pitch explaining why this approach should be adopted.

Pitch notes:

Evaluate: Back to Paper

Tick one score for each criterion. Use the notes sections to prepare your anti-pitch and rebuttal.

1 Very weak	2 Weak	3 Mixed	4 Strong	5 Very strong
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Criterion	Key question	1	2	3	4	5
Learning value	Does it encourage meaningful learning?					
Validity	Does the mark provide credible evidence of understanding?					
Fairness	Is it equitable and inclusive?					
AI resilience	Does it remain credible when students can use AI?					
Practicality	Is it manageable for more than 500 students?					

TOTAL SCORE: _____ / 25

STRONGEST FEATURE

BIGGEST WEAKNESS

ROUND 2: ANTI-PITCH NOTES

Sketch out why this approach should not be adopted without modification.

ROUND 3: REBUTTAL NOTES

Sketch out your response to the anti-pitch and defend the scenario.

Detect and Deter

Students complete an online MCQ assessment, with safeguards used to discourage inappropriate use of AI.

HOW IT WORKS

- Students complete a timed online assessment with randomised questions and answer options.
- Strict time limits and clear academic-integrity guidance act as deterrents.
- Activity logs are reviewed for unusual patterns, such as very rapid completion or repeated navigation away from the page.
- Suspicious cases may trigger a follow-up discussion, an additional task, or an academic-integrity investigation.

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Practice, Track, Validate

Students build a record of performance through regular practice, which is confirmed through a short invigilated validation exercise.

HOW IT WORKS

- Students complete frequent low-stakes MCQ practice throughout the module.
- Questions are dynamically generated or selected from a large bank to reduce memorisation.
- The system tracks engagement, topic coverage, accuracy, improvement, and consistency over time.
- A short invigilated activity confirms that the longer-term record is credible.

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Open-Book by Design

Students may use AI and other resources, but questions are designed to reward application and critical judgement.

HOW IT WORKS

- Students may use notes, textbooks, websites, and generative AI tools during the assessment.
- Questions focus on unfamiliar cases, interpretation, evaluation, and decision-making.
- Students may be asked to critique an AI-generated answer or choose between several plausible explanations.
- MCQs can be combined with short justifications, confidence ratings, or follow-up questions.

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Reward the Work

Students earn marks through sustained MCQ practice, with regular limits used to reward consistent engagement rather than last-minute activity.

HOW IT WORKS

- The module is divided into weekly or fortnightly windows, each with a fixed amount of credit available.
- Students earn marks for correctly answering a defined number of questions within each window.
- Credit is capped by topic or learning objective to encourage breadth and prevent easy-question farming.
- A limited number of missed windows can be discounted or recovered to account for short-term disruption.

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